



Polygon Pedagogues

Safer Recruitment Policy

Recruiting and retaining adults who are safe to work with children

Policy owner	Mohsin Abbas, Primary DSL
Approved by	Hammad Ahmad, Company Director and Deputy DSL
Version	V1.0
Effective from	01 September 2026
Next review due	01 September 2027
Policy category	Safeguarding and Safer Recruitment
Applies to	All directors, staff, tutors, volunteers, contractors, agency workers and applicants

Safer Recruitment Contacts

No adult starts work with learners until the checks and safeguards required for the role have been completed, reviewed and recorded. If an immediate safeguarding concern arises, call 999 where necessary and report it to the DSL without delay.

Role	Contact details
Primary DSL and policy owner	Mohsin Abbas dsl@polygonpedagogues.co.uk 07305 237933
Deputy DSL and Company Director	Hammad Ahmad director@polygonpedagogues.co.uk 07555 854902
Recruitment or suitability concern	Report immediately to the DSL or Deputy DSL. Do not permit work with learners pending review.
Emergency action	999 - immediate danger or urgent medical emergency. Then notify the DSL as soon as possible.

Contents

1. Purpose and scope	2. Legal and guidance framework
3. Safer recruitment principles	4. Roles and responsibilities
5. Recruitment planning and advertising	6. Application, shortlisting and interview
7. References and employment history	8. Pre-appointment checks
9. DBS, barred list and regulated activity	10. Right to work and overseas checks
11. Suitability decisions and risk assessment	12. Single central record and data protection
13. Agency, contractor and visitor assurance	14. Induction, probation and ongoing suitability
15. Allegations, low-level concerns and referrals	16. Policy assurance and review
Appendix A: Pre-appointment checklist	Appendix B: Suitability decision record
Appendix C: Safer recruitment compliance record	

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how Polygon Pedagogues recruits, checks, appoints, inducts and monitors adults who work with or may have contact with children and young people. It applies to directors, employees, self-employed tutors, subcontractors, agency workers, consultants, volunteers and any person engaged to deliver or support tuition, alternative education, outreach or SEMH mentoring.

Polygon Pedagogues provides private and commissioned one-to-one and small-group tuition in homes, schools, libraries, community venues and online. It is not a registered school at the date of this policy, but it follows education-sector safer recruitment expectations as a professional safeguarding benchmark. The welfare of children takes priority over operational pressure or the need to fill a role quickly.

This policy is read alongside the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy, staff code of conduct, allegations and low-level concerns arrangements, whistleblowing arrangements, data protection policy and commissioning contracts.

2. Legal and guidance framework

This policy is informed by current law and guidance in England, including Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026, Working Together to Safeguard Children, the Children Act 1989 and 2004, the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006, the Protection of Freedoms Act 2012, the Equality Act 2010, the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974, the Data Protection Act 2018, UK GDPR, DBS eligibility guidance and Home Office right-to-work guidance.

The precise level of vetting depends on the legal eligibility and duties of the role. No check is requested merely as a preference. Conversely, a check that is legally available is not treated as the only safeguard: safer recruitment considers the whole suitability picture.

3. Safer recruitment principles

- Safeguarding suitability is considered throughout recruitment and continuing employment, not only when a DBS certificate is received.
- Selection is fair, evidence-based, consistent and proportionate. Reasonable adjustments are made where appropriate, but safeguarding requirements are not weakened.
- Information that is incomplete, inconsistent, vague or concerning is explored before appointment. A gap in history is not automatically disqualifying, but it is not ignored.
- No adult begins unsupervised or direct work with learners until the checks and clearance required for the role are complete and recorded.

4. Roles and responsibilities

The Company Director ensures that safer recruitment is resourced, applied consistently and reviewed. The Primary DSL advises on safeguarding issues arising during recruitment, reviews any concern that could affect child safety and ensures that recruitment learning connects with safeguarding practice. The Deputy DSL acts with appropriate authority when the DSL is unavailable.

Recruiting managers and interviewers follow this policy, use structured questions, record decisions and escalate concerns. At least one person involved in appointment decisions has appropriate safer recruitment training or knowledge. Every applicant provides accurate information and cooperates with reasonable checks. Appointed personnel must disclose changes that may affect their suitability.

5. Recruitment planning and advertising

Before advertising, the recruiting manager defines the duties, level of learner contact, whether teaching or instruction is provided, whether the role is online or home-based, access to records, supervision arrangements, and the legal eligibility for DBS and barred-list checks. The role description includes expected conduct, safeguarding responsibilities, qualifications and experience.

Recruitment materials state that Polygon Pedagogues is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children, that appointment is subject to satisfactory safer recruitment checks, and that the individual must follow relevant policies. Candidates are told that false or incomplete information may lead to withdrawal of an offer or action after appointment.

6. Application, shortlisting and interview

The application process obtains a full employment and education history, relevant qualifications, experience with children and SEND, professional registrations where applicable, right-to-work details, declarations and contact details for referees. A CV alone is not sufficient where a full history is required.

Shortlisting compares evidence against the role criteria and identifies unexplained gaps, inconsistent dates, unclear duties, repeated short roles, missing references or other matters requiring exploration. Any online search is undertaken only where lawful, relevant, proportionate, consistently applied and recorded.

Interviews use structured safeguarding questions. They explore motivation for working with children, professional boundaries, confidentiality, online and home-tuition safety, response to disclosures, working with parents and commissioners, SEND inclusion and ability to follow reporting procedures. Interview decisions record evidence, not assumptions.

7. References and employment history

References are obtained from appropriate professional referees before appointment wherever possible. They are checked for authenticity and reviewed rather than filed unread. A vague, unusually limited, inconsistent or concerning reference is followed up with the referee and, where appropriate, the applicant before a decision is made.

The recruitment record shows how gaps and inconsistencies were explored. Explanations are assessed fairly and proportionately, but recruitment does not proceed where concerns cannot be resolved or a safe decision cannot be justified.

8. Pre-appointment checks

Before a person begins work, Polygon Pedagogues completes and records the checks required for the role. These normally include identity, address where necessary, right to work, qualifications and professional status where relevant, employment history, references, DBS eligibility and results where applicable, barred-list information where legally permitted, and overseas criminal-record or conduct information where relevant.

A conditional offer may be made, but clearance is not assumed. Where a check raises a concern, work with learners does not begin until an authorised person has completed and recorded a suitability assessment. In exceptional operational circumstances, an alternative, lawful and documented arrangement is only used following senior approval and must not expose children to avoidable risk.

9. DBS, barred list and regulated activity

Polygon Pedagogues determines the correct DBS level using current DBS eligibility guidance and the actual duties of the role. Many tuition roles involve teaching, training, instruction, care or supervision of children. Where the legal criteria for regulated activity with children are met, the organisation obtains an Enhanced DBS check with Children's Barred List information before the individual starts that activity.

From 1 September 2026, the previous supervision exemption in the definition of regulated activity with children has been removed. Each role is assessed against the current statutory definition rather than assumptions about job titles, self-employment or whether a person is paid.

A person barred from regulated activity with children must not be permitted to engage in it. A DBS certificate or Update Service status is one part of the decision, not a substitute for references, interview evidence, conduct information, supervision and ongoing safeguarding oversight. DBS certificate information is handled securely and retained only as long as necessary.

10. Right to work and overseas checks

Right-to-work checks are completed before employment or engagement begins, using the current prescribed Home Office route. The person conducting the check must be satisfied that the person presenting the evidence is the person who will carry out the work. Follow-up checks are tracked where the individual has time-limited permission to work.

A DBS check does not reveal overseas criminal records. Where an applicant has lived or worked outside the UK, Polygon Pedagogues considers whether an overseas criminal-record check, certificate of good conduct, professional reference or other additional assurance is necessary, taking account of the role, country, duration, recency and available official routes.

11. Suitability decisions and risk assessment

A criminal record, gap, disclosed concern or other issue does not automatically prevent appointment unless it makes the person unsuitable or legally unable to undertake the role. Decisions are fair, individualised, evidence-based and documented. The relevant information is assessed in relation to the duties, learner vulnerability, pattern and seriousness of conduct, timing, honesty, rehabilitation evidence, references and professional advice.

Where risk can be managed safely, controls may include a revised role, supervision, additional training, restrictions or review points. Where risk cannot be safely managed, the appointment does not proceed. Decisions are made by authorised senior leaders with DSL input where safeguarding risk arises.

12. Single central record and data protection

Polygon Pedagogues maintains a single central record or equivalent safer recruitment compliance record. It records the checks required for each person, dates completed, person verifying the evidence, DBS level and result category where applicable, clearance decision, right-to-work follow-up date and training status. The record supports oversight; it does not replace the underlying evidence or decision record. Recruitment, DBS and suitability information is special or highly sensitive personal data in many cases. It is accessed only by authorised people, stored securely, shared on a need-to-know basis and retained in line with the Data Protection, Privacy and GDPR Policy.

Unsuccessful applicant information is normally kept for six months unless a longer period is necessary for a legal claim or the applicant agrees otherwise.

13. Agency, contractor and visitor assurance

When an agency, subcontractor, consultant or partner supplies a worker, Polygon Pedagogues obtains written assurance that checks appropriate to the role have been completed, including identity, right to work, DBS and barred-list status where legally permitted, references, qualifications and safeguarding training. The arrangement identifies who holds the underlying evidence and how concerns are escalated.

Assurance from another organisation does not remove Polygon Pedagogues' responsibility for a safe environment. Before working with learners, external adults are given the relevant safeguarding procedures, DSL contacts, conduct expectations, communication boundaries, information-sharing route and reporting duties. Visitors are supervised or restricted according to risk.

14. Induction, probation and ongoing suitability

Safer recruitment continues after appointment. Before contact with learners, new personnel complete induction covering safeguarding, professional boundaries, responding to concerns and disclosures, allegations and low-level concerns, whistleblowing, online safety, data protection, lone working, home-tuition expectations, incident reporting and the use of approved systems.

Suitability is monitored through supervision, training, quality assurance, session records, attendance patterns, feedback, conduct reviews and safeguarding learning. All staff and tutors must tell the DSL or Director promptly about criminal investigations, cautions, convictions, professional restrictions, safeguarding enquiries or conduct outside work that may affect suitability.

15. Allegations, low-level concerns and referrals

An allegation or concern about an adult is not handled only as a recruitment or HR matter. It is reported immediately under the Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy and the allegations procedure. The DSL seeks advice from the Local Authority Designated Officer, police, children's social care, DBS or another appropriate body where the threshold or legal duty is met. Low-level concerns, poor boundaries and conduct that may not meet the harm threshold are recorded and reviewed for patterns. Polygon Pedagogues makes a DBS referral where it is a regulated activity provider or personnel supplier and the statutory referral criteria are met. Retaliation against anyone raising a genuine concern is not permitted.

16. Policy assurance and review

The DSL and Company Director review safer recruitment practice at least annually and sooner if law, DBS guidance, safeguarding guidance, commissioned arrangements, service delivery or an incident requires it. Review activity includes sampling the compliance record, checking overdue actions, reviewing suitability decisions, confirming training and learning from concerns.

Significant updates are communicated to staff, tutors, agencies and commissioners as appropriate. This policy remains a working safeguard only if it is understood, consistently applied and supported by prompt action when concerns arise.

Appendix A: Pre-appointment checklist

Use this checklist for every employee, tutor, contractor, volunteer, director or agency worker. The exact checks depend on the legal eligibility and duties of the role.

Check	Required evidence / action
Role assessment	Role description, learner contact, online/home work, access to records, supervision, DBS/barred-list eligibility documented.
Candidate information	Application, full work and education history, declarations, qualifications and relevant experience checked.
Identity and right to work	Identity verified; current prescribed right-to-work check completed before start; follow-up date recorded where needed.
References	Appropriate professional references obtained, authenticated, reviewed and clarified where necessary.
DBS and overseas assurance	Correct DBS level confirmed; Children's Barred List information obtained where legally permitted; overseas checks considered where relevant.
Decision and clearance	Any concern assessed and recorded; authorised clearance given; person added to compliance record before work with learners begins.
Induction	Safeguarding, conduct, reporting routes, data protection, online/home-tuition and training requirements completed.

Appendix B: Suitability decision record

Complete this record where a disclosure, reference, DBS result, gap or other information needs a documented assessment before appointment or continuation in role.

Field	Record
Information considered	Factual summary; source; role duties; learner contact and vulnerability; date received.
Risk factors	Relevance, seriousness, pattern, timing, honesty, evidence of rehabilitation, references, professional advice and legal restrictions.
Protective factors	Training, supervision, role restrictions, evidence of conduct, credible explanation, monitoring or other controls.
Decision	Clear, conditional with safeguards, not appointed / not permitted to start, or referral / advice required.
Authorisation and review	Decision-maker; DSL input; date; rationale; follow-up owner and review date.

Appendix C: Safer recruitment compliance record

The central compliance record is maintained securely and reviewed regularly. It records the completion status and dates of required checks; it does not contain unnecessary DBS certificate detail.

Record field	Minimum information
Person and role	Name, role, engagement type, start date, line manager.
Identity / right to work	Date verified, verifier, evidence route, follow-up date if applicable.
References / history	Dates received and reviewed; gaps explored; clearance outcome.
DBS / barred list	Eligibility decision, check level, date, certificate reference or Update Service check, barred-list status where applicable.
Overseas / qualifications	Checks and qualifications required for the role; date verified.
Induction / training	Safeguarding and safer recruitment induction completed; refresher or renewal dates.
Clearance and review	Clearance date; restrictions; next review; concern route.